



Nikon D4 & D800 Launched

Nikon has launched the D4, D800, and D800E, sporting the with FX-format CMOS sensors at prices ₹3,24,950, ₹1,49,950 and ₹1,64,950 <http://dgit.in/GGybnG>

Desire HD price slashed

HTC Desire HD Android smartphone cheaper by ₹8,000, bringing it to just ₹18,990. <http://dgit.in/GEIrde>

Motherboard Comparison

BIOS' which we feel is a bit gimmicky as it is not 3D in any way. But yes, they have tried to make navigating the BIOS menu somewhat easier for novices, although we feel that seasoned enthusiasts wouldn't care less with the implementation. With the Gigabyte Boards, we managed to comfortably cross 4.4 GHz on both the boards on manual overclocking. The preset OC settings worked only till 4.2 GHz whereas on 4.4 GHz we were facing the BSOD.

On the ASRock boards, the UEFI BIOS is not as impressive as the ones seen on MSI or ASUS boards, but it is easy to navigate. It offers easy overclocking settings from 4 GHz all the way upto 5.2 GHz. We could pull it to 4.6 GHz on manual overclocking and around 4.4 GHz on easy overclocking using the preset modes, on both boards. The Extreme 9 offers two 8-pin power connectors which are a boon for extreme overclockers.

The UEFI BIOS of Biostar is very straight forward without any home page for easily accessing specific menus. The O.N.E section offers manual overclocking options. You can also

use the utility Toverclocker to OC from the Windows OS. There are no preset overclocking options in the BIOS though, as were seen in ASRock or ASUS boards. We could get upto 4.4 GHz, but the system would crash during the Cinebench R11.5 benchmark so we settled on 4.3 GHz overclock.

With ECS it is possible to overclock with the help of Quick OC and OC Profiles. We faced quite some issues during manual overclocking as adjusting the multiplier needs you to change CPU Ratio settings from Turbo to Manual and then proceed. Manual overclocking by changing the BCLK is easy. On the whole the manual overclocking experience is not as smooth as we saw on ASUS or ASRock or MSI boards.

Overclocking the ASUS ROG boards is quite easy thanks to the sheer number of ways in which that is possible. For starters, you have the AI Suite II which has preset OC modes, which just require you to select the desired speed and reboot the system. The BIOS is very user friendly and very exhaustive to the point that it may seem a bit intimidating for an amateur overclocker. Adjusting the BCLK and multiplier, DRAM



MSI Big Bang XPower II

settings, voltages etc., through the BIOS is very easy. ROG connect offers you the ability to monitor and tweak settings via another laptop which is connected via a USB port to the ROG board. Yet another way, a bit gimmicky though, to overclock your PC is via your cellphone or tablet via iDirect app.

While overclocking we could easily scale 4.5 GHz on all the boards, with the Rampage IV Extreme going all the way to 4.7 GHz giving a 30 per cent jump in Cinebench R11.5 rendering scores.

Winners

We divided the motherboards into three price brackets. The overall **Best Buy** award went to **ASUS Rampage IV Extreme** for the fabulous feature-set offered for enthusiast community. The ease of using UEFI BIOS, sheer

number of ways to overclock and monitor the settings is what sets the Rampage IV Extreme apart from the rest of the boards in its category. MSI Big Bang XPower II is also very good, but its pricing is off the charts.

In the Under ₹20,000 category the **ASUS Rampage IV Gene** scored the **Best Buy** award for its enthusiast oriented feature set at good pricing. You can even do 3-way SLI or CrossfireX on this micro-ATX board. **ASRock X79 Extreme 6/GB** won the **Editor's Pick** for its great overall feature set and being the only board under ₹20,000 to bundle in a gaming cum networking card.

In the ₹20,000 to ₹24,000 bracket, **Gigabyte X79-UD5** offered the best value for money, bagging the **Best Buy** award. ASUS Sabertooth X79 was a strong contender, but lost out on overall score and pricing.

Contact details

Brand	Phone	Email	Website
ASRock	886919-457786	manoj_kriplani@asrock.com.tw	www.asrock.com
ASUS	+91 22 6766 8800	reachus@asus.com	www.asus.in
Biostar	+91 22 4091 4615	marketing@abacusperipherals.com	www.biostar.com.tw
ECS	NA	joyce.cl.wu@ecs.com.tw	www.ecs.com.tw
Gigabyte	+91 22 4063 3218	anilkumarr@gigabyte.in	www.gigabyte.in
Intel	+91 22 6713 7009	NA	www.intel.com
MSI	+91 11 4175 8808	bishakhadas@msi.com	www.in.msi.com

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